

>hackathon_ Essentials



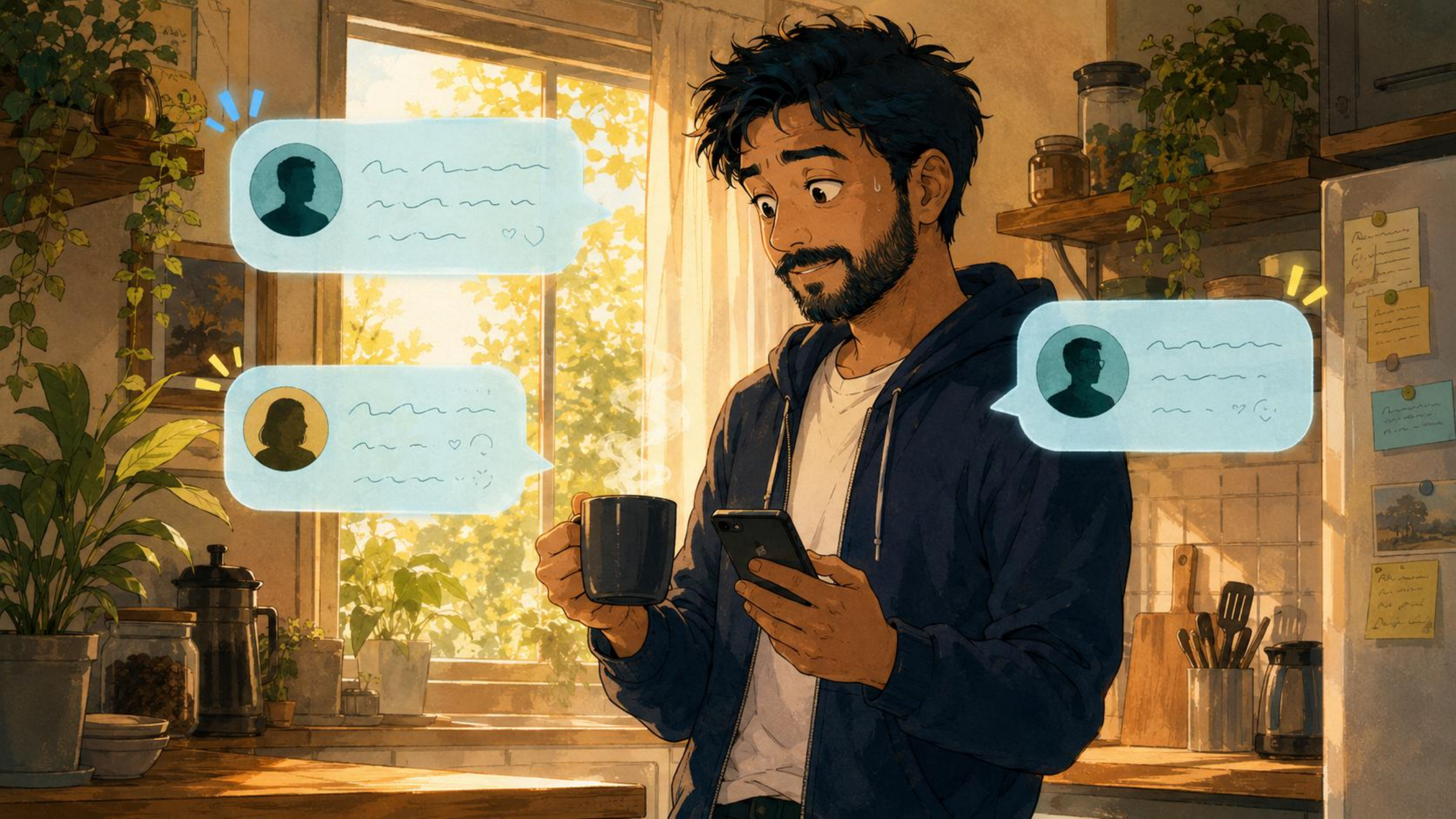
Institutionalize Your Instincts to Skills (Part 1/2)

Tezan Sahu

19th August 2-3 PM

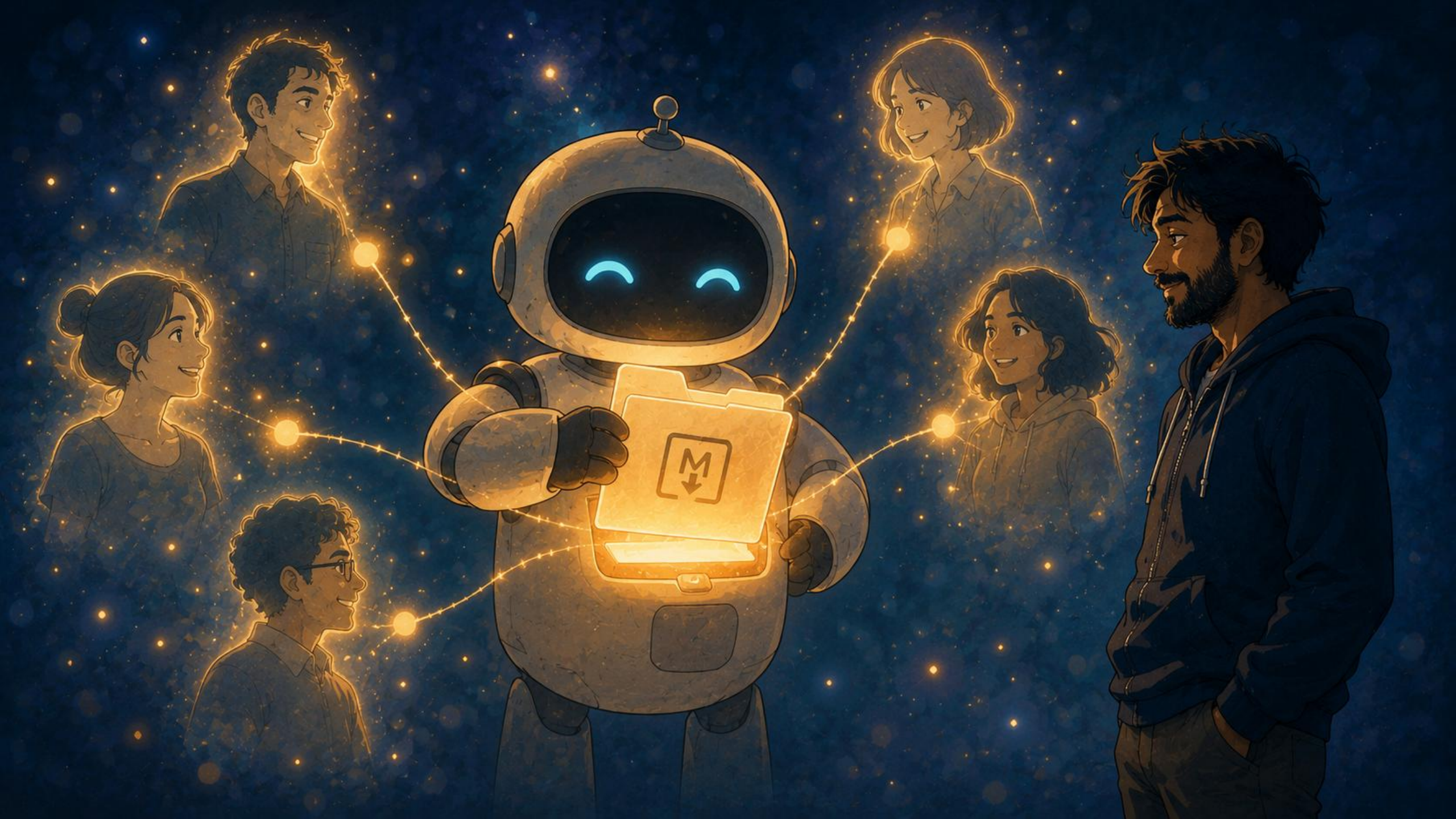
aka.ms/HackathonEssentials











The next AI leap is not a better model.

**It is a better package for your
standards, context, and taste.**

*Every team has someone whose AI outputs are consistently better.
Agent Skills make that quality installable and shareable.*

Institutionalize your *Instincts* into *Skills*

Encoding expertise, taste, and tribal knowledge into reusable AI skills.

SkillUp AI

Microsoft Garage

Tezan Sahu · Applied Scientist II · M365 Core IDC

A little about me.

- **Microsoft IDC (2021 - Present)**
 - Applied Scientist II (2025 -) · M365 Copilot Extensibility
 - Software Engineer II (2024 - 25) · M365 Copilot Extensibility
 - Data & Applied Scientist II (2023 - 24) · Bing Autosuggest + Search History
 - Data & Applied Scientist (2021 - 23) · Bing Autosuggest
- **IIT Bombay (2017 - 21)**
 - Institute Rank 2
 - Major Mech. Engg. 9.90/10
 - Minor CSE
- Author · **Beyond Code** (National Bestseller)
- Author · **Low-Pass Filter** — an AI newsletter
- 9* US Patents · 5 Research Papers
- Empowered **25,000+ students & professionals** in AI & Data Science



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The agenda.

01 The pain you've been ignoring

Repeated prompts, tribal knowledge, the libraries nobody uses.

02 What a Skill actually is

A folder. A markdown file. Progressive disclosure. That's it.

03 Where they already run

Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and the M365 Copilot direction.

04 Skills built for this room

For engineers, data folks, PMs, finance, HR, consulting.

05 Live build - under 5 minutes

One skill, from blank repo to working tool, on stage.

06 Principles & your challenge

How to write skills that don't suck. What to build this week.

Sound familiar?

The same 200 words. Every chat.

Write this in our team's voice, headings, checklist, and handoff format. Copy-pasted every time.

Expertise that lives in one head.

Nuance never reaches the agent until that person is OOF, changes org, or leaves.

Prompt libraries nobody uses.

Built with love. Announced in all-hands.
Forgotten by Friday.

The quiet bottleneck.

One person becomes the AI whisperer and a single point of failure.

Stop writing *prompts*. Start installing *skills*.

Prompt era

You carry the expertise.
Repeat it in every chat.
It leaves with you.



AFTER

Skills era

The agent holds it.
Install once.
The repo carries it.

A skill is a folder.

```
my-skill/  
├── SKILL.md  
├── scripts/  
├── references/  
└── assets/
```

No SDK.
No framework.
No pipeline.

name

Unique ID. Lowercase-hyphen. Always loaded.

description

Most critical field. It tells the agent when and why to load.

body

Step-by-step instructions, checklists, and examples loaded only on match.

sub-files

Referenced docs and scripts loaded only when needed inside the skill.

Progressive disclosure.

LEVEL 01 • ALWAYS ON

Name + Description

~20-50 tokens per skill.
Loaded at startup for all
installed skills.

LEVEL 02 • ON MATCH

Full SKILL.md body

Loaded only when your
request matches the skill.

LEVEL 03 • ON DEMAND

Sub-files & scripts

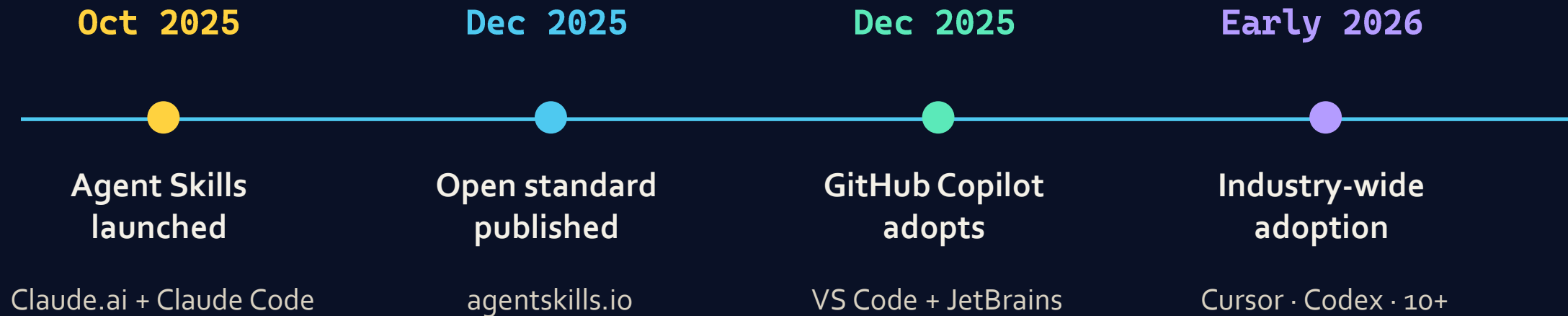
Loaded only when the
matched skill needs
specific sub-tasks.

DON'T CONFUSE THESE

Skills vs Agents.

	Skills	Agents
What it is	Packaged expertise for an existing agent.	Autonomous loop: plan -> act -> observe.
Who builds it	Anyone who can write Markdown.	Engineers with frameworks and orchestration.
Build time	15 - 30 minutes.	Days to weeks.
Portability	Works across Claude, Copilot, Cursor, etc..	Tied to the framework used.
Use when	You need standards applied consistently.	You need tools, APIs, or system wiring.

A short origin story.



**MCP did this for tools.
Skills are doing it for expertise.**

Skills in GitHub Copilot.

Directory locations

`.github/skills/<skill-name>/SKILL.md`

`.claude/skills/<skill-name>/SKILL.md`

`~/.copilot/skills/<skill-name>/SKILL.md`

Claude Code skills are auto-recognized by GitHub Copilot.

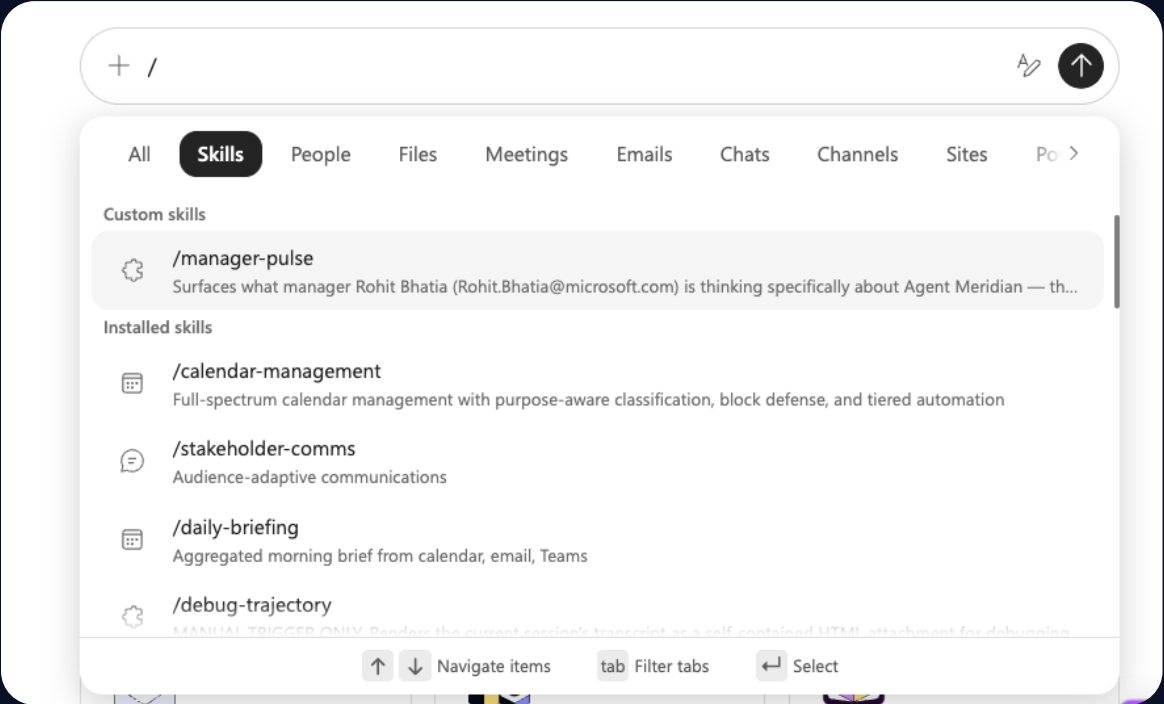
Settings *(don't miss these)*

VS Code: chat.useAgentSkills -> Enable

JetBrains: Enable Agent Skills (Preview)

Enterprise: enable Editor preview features first

Skills in M365 Copilot & Cowork



LSEG

LSEG Copilot Cowork
Created by [LSEG Financial Analytics](#)

Request access

This plugin is blocked by your organization's policy.

Cowork plugin for financial analysis workflows

The LSEG plugin integrates LSEG financial data — covering bonds, FX, rates, swaps, and equities — directly into Cowork. **Key benefits:** • Run multi-tool financial analysis in a single slash command, without switching between data sources. • Access domain-aware workflows across asset classes, from FX spot rates to bond analytics. • Stay within... [Show more](#)

MCP servers

LSEG MCP Server

Remote MCP server providing tools for LSEG

Skills

bond-futures-basis

Analyze the bond futures basis by pricing futures, identifying the cheapest-to-deliver, and comparing with yield curves to assess delivery option value and basis trading opportunities. Use when analyzing bond futures, computing the basis,...

bond-relative-value

Perform relative value analysis on bonds by combining pricing, yield curve context, credit spreads. Use when analyzing bond richness/cheapness, computing spread decomposition, comparing bonds, assessing bond value vs curves.

fx-carry-trade

Evaluate FX carry trade opportunities by combining spot rates, forward points, interest rate differentials, volatility surface analysis, and historical price trends. Use when analyzing carry trades, comparing FX forward curves, assessing carry-to-v...

[Show more](#)

Details

Version
1.0.7

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WRITE ONCE, RUN EVERYWHERE

The open standard ecosystem.

HOSTS

Claude Code · GitHub Copilot · OpenAI Codex · Cursor · VS Code · Windsurf · Amp · Goose · Letta · OpenCode

LAUNCH PARTNERS

Atlassian · Canva · Cloudflare · Figma · Notion · Ramp · Sentry · Stripe · Zapier

github.com/anthropics/skills

Official Anthropic skills · Apache 2.0

github.com/github/awesome-copilot

GitHub community skills, growing fast

skills.sh

Discovery hub · 150+ skills across hosts

Skills built for this room.

Engineers

/code-review — team conventions
/pr-description — PR template
/oncall-triage — runbook actions
/repo-onboard — ramp-up brief

Data & Applied Science

/eda-template — six diagnostics
/kusto-build — NL to KQL
/experiment-design — A/B and sample size
/scrape-analysis — metric and RCA

Product Managers

/spec-writer — team PRD format
/feedback-synthesis — themed clusters
/competitor-tear-down — positioning
/release-notes — git to notes

Finance

/variance-analysis — MBR commentary
/mbr-deck — numbers to narrative
/close-checklist — month-end steps
/forecast-template — 3-driver model

HR & People

/jd-writer — employer voice
/interview-debrief — panel synthesis
/perf-review-draft — calibration draft
/onboarding-plan — 30/60/90

Consulting & Strategy

/stakeholder-synth — insight memo
/mece-outline — structured outline
/exec-summary — 3-sentence brief
/slide-narrative — action title

Live build

Install Anthropic's "skill-creator" skill

```
npx skills install  
https://github.com/anthropics/skills/tree/main/skills/skill-creator
```

Use the skill to institutionalize YOUR workflow

/weekly-update.

Create a skill called **weekly-update** that takes raw bullet points about my week and produces a 5-sentence update with sections Wins / Risks / Asks, written in a confident but humble Microsoft IC voice.

Trigger when I say "weekly update", "Friday note", or paste rough end-of-week bullets.

1. **Describe the gap** — clarify trigger and workflow.
2. skill-creator **scaffolds** SKILL.md and folder.
3. Run on a **real** weekly example and **inspect output**.
4. **Commit** in `.claude/skills/` or `.github/skills/`.

Design principles.

Description is the hero shot

The only field read before triggering.
Be specific and keyword-rich.

One skill, one job

A skill that does five things does all five poorly.

Start lean, Grow with evidence

Begin minimal. Add sub-files only when missing context appears.

Write for the agent

Numbered steps and checklists beat ambiguous prose.

Iterate with the agent

Ask what was missing after each run and refine.

Test on real work

Use 3-5 real examples before calling a skill done.

Your challenge.

today · step 01

**Find your
one workflow.**

The thing you repeat
most and wish the
agent already knew.

today · step 02

**Run
skill-creator.**

Help me create a skill
for [workflow],
triggered by [context].

this week · step 03

**Test on
real work.**

Use 3 actual examples
from your week and ask
what is missing.

this week · step 04

**Share and
commit.**

Send it to one
teammate and commit
to [.github/skills/](#).

**You know your domain better than any AI.
You just need to write it down in a folder.**

THAT'S ALL, FOLKS

Go... Institutionalize your instincts.

Build one this week. Send me what you ship.



Connect on LinkedIn

linkedin.com/in/tezan-sahu



Read Low-Pass Filter

lowpassfilter.substack.com